

Inventory System API

Overdue Notifications — Reference for Frontend Integration

Overview

The backend automatically checks for overdue loans every 10 minutes (an item is overdue once its `due_date` has passed and it hasn't been returned yet). When one is found, a notification is created exactly once for that loan. These two endpoints let the admin dashboard list notifications and mark them as read once viewed.

GET /admin/notifications

Method	GET
Path	/admin/notifications
Base URL (local dev)	http://localhost:8080
Auth required	Yes — Bearer token

Query Parameters (optional)

- `?unread=true` — returns only notifications that haven't been marked as read yet. Omit this parameter to get all notifications.

Success Response

Status: 200 OK — an array of notification objects, most recent first.

```
[
{
  "id": 1,
  "loan_id": 3,
  "message": "Item \"MacBook Pro\" borrowed by Jane Doe is overdue (was due 2026-07-01 10:00:00).",
  "is_read": false,
  "created_at": "2026-07-08T09:15:00Z"
}
```

Returns an empty array `[]` if there are no notifications yet — not an error.

Response Fields

Field	Type	Description
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id	number	Notification's own ID — use this to mark it read.
loan_id	number	The loan this notification is about.
message	string	Human-readable summary, ready to display as-is.
is_read	boolean	Whether the admin has already viewed/dismissed this notification.
created_at	string	ISO 8601 timestamp of when the notification was generated.

Example (curl)

```
# All notifications
curl http://localhost:8080/admin/notifications \
-H "Authorization: Bearer <token>"

# Unread only
curl "http://localhost:8080/admin/notifications?unread=true" \
-H "Authorization: Bearer <token>"
```

PUT /admin/notifications/:id/read

Method	PUT
Path	/admin/notifications/:id/read
Base URL (local dev)	http://localhost:8080
Auth required	Yes — Bearer token

Path Parameter

- `:id` — the notification's `id` field (not the `loan_id`).

Success Response

Status: 200 OK

```
{
  "message": "marked as read"
}
```

Error Responses

Status	Body	Cause
400	{"error": "invalid id"}	Non-numeric id in the URL
404	{"error": "notification not found"}	No notification exists with that id
401	{"error": "missing or malformed authorization header"}	No token provided

401	{"error":"invalid or expired token"}	Token malformed, tampered, or expired
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Example (curl)

```
curl -X PUT http://localhost:8080/admin/notifications/1/read \  
-H "Authorization: Bearer <token>"
```

Suggested Frontend Behavior

- Poll GET /admin/notifications?unread=true periodically (e.g. every 1-2 minutes) to show a badge count or toast for new overdue alerts.
- When the admin opens/views the notifications panel, call the mark-as-read endpoint for each notification they've seen, or when they explicitly dismiss one.
- The message field is already formatted for display — no need to reconstruct it from loan_id on the frontend.
- New notifications only appear after the backend's periodic check runs (every 10 minutes), not instantly the moment an item becomes overdue — so there can be up to a 10-minute delay between an item going overdue and a notification appearing.